

Symptoms as Opportunities

Hello everybody. In today's bonus broadcast, I wanted to talk about symptoms as an opportunity for you. My guess is that you don't have a good relationship to your symptoms, and I don't think I'm wrong about that. When they show up, we're not happy about it. We don't want it to be there. Especially, I find this to be really applicable.

If you've been having any good moments or hours or days when those symptoms come up, there's this initial feeling that it's bad and that we wish it wasn't there. So in today's broadcast, I wanna help you change the perspective here. This is very important to remember as you are doing this rewiring process and changing your response to your symptoms.

The only time that you are going to get the chance to rewire anything is when the symptoms show up. You need the symptoms, you need them to show up. You don't have any opportunity to practice responding differently when everything is fine, when you're feeling happy, when you're having really low symptoms.

It only exists when something uncomfortable shows up. So I wanna give you a new question to ask yourself instead of doing what you normally do. The way you normally react, which is, oh my God, how do I make this stop? I want you to play around with something that I started doing that really helped me to change the entire vibe of this experience, which we already know is tough enough on its own.

Instead of asking what you normally ask or responding the way you normally do, I want you to ask yourself instead, how well can I respond here? How well can I respond to these symptoms? This is a shift that is gonna take you out of this place of, I'm a victim to my symptom, to someone with agency, not, not someone who needs to respond perfectly.

Just how well can I respond here? How differently can I respond than how I normally respond? So you can ask yourself, I know how I normally respond to this. What is the literal, most opposite of what I normally do? How can I do that now? Almost to a silly

degree, this is one of those things that really lightens the pressure, which of course we know is going to help with turning the alarm down.

It gives you something positive to focus on. And it turns these moments that have been like really dreaded moments for us into almost a game. We're gamifying this process. It's just asking yourself, let's just see what I can do with this one. And even more than that, it utilizes the energy that you normally spend panicking, and it funnels that energy into this internal challenge.

Instead, it's another way to use that energy that already exists at the beginning. This is gonna feel silly and ridiculous and impossible, but that's just because you've been responding to these things the same way over and over again for such a long period of time. But over time, what you're gonna notice is your response is changing more and more with practice, and eventually that becomes the new automatic response until you will get to a point where there's barely even a response at all.

Your symptoms will come up and you'll just be so disinterested in them that they won't get any of your attention. You are not there yet. You're probably on the other side of that scale. So this is one of these really easy ways where instead of jumping into what you normally do, we can, um, on purpose ask ourself a question that basically is asking, how do I use this opportunity the best possible way that I can?

How do I use this opportunity to heal? 'cause those are the moments you guys, that you are healing. Those are the moments that matter the most. They're, they're are the moments. In the past, I would talk about this as like being on the clock. Like, this is your time to shine. This is, you're, you're on the clock.

This is what you're getting paid for. This is, this is what pays off. How well can I respond to this right now? How can I be, and if, and if that's too big of a question, how can I respond 20% better to this than I normally do? Give yourself whatever space you need, meet yourself where you're at, but in time, get silly about it.

Like, because it's going to be so polar opposite of what's normal for you. And that in and of itself is something that benefits neuroplasticity. The, that, that interruption of, I normally just respond. I do it automatically and instead we stop, we pause for a second and we go, okay. How can I just do my best with this?

How can I take this opportunity, use it in a way where I end up at the end of the day, really proud of myself that I was able to have a completely new relationship with what I was experiencing. And then celebrate yourself. Because you know, after going through the course that that is what rewires the system.

It is the response, and it is the relationship. It's our number one priority, and this is a way to make that a little bit easier on yourself. This is not about being hard on yourself when you don't respond well. There were many times where I tried this and it did not work well. I was just too overwhelmed by what I was feeling, and I was like, this isn't.

This isn't my shot here. I, I not how I would've wanted to respond, but there's always next time. But as you get started, I want you to see it as more of a curiosity. Like, huh? Like, let's just see how this goes. Let's, let's see what I can do with this. That is a lightness in this process that is so important, and we can't keep all of this so heavy.

It's already challenging enough. It's already hard enough. Any way that you can lighten things up or lighten the goals, uh, lighten the pressure is going to be helpful for you.